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MNOP & PNOP

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Mail Network Optimization Project (MNOP)

Introduction and Scope

The Mail Network Optimization Project (MNOP) was initiated as part of an **11th plan scheme** in **March 2010** and adopted by the Department of Posts in **Nov 2010** to bring efficiency, transparency, and accountability to Mail Operations. Initially implemented for Speed Post, it was later extended to Registered articles.

Key Changes and Benefits

The implementation of MNOP introduced several key changes and benefits to India Post:

1. Simplification of Network

The Speed Post Network has been optimized by creating **95 National Sorting Hubs (NSHs)** and **163 Intra Circle Hubs (ICHs)**, compared to **315 National Speed Post Centres (NSPC)** and **890 State Speed Post Centres (SPC)** earlier. This consolidation facilitates the simple tracking of delayed or misplaced consignments.

2. Use of Adequate Equipment

Infrastructure upgradation at mail offices under MNOP includes the introduction of new equipment to improve not only the efficiency and effectiveness of staff but also working conditions.

3. Optimisation of Layout

The layout of Speed Post hubs has been redesigned to facilitate an assembly-line flow of mail, minimizing wasteful movement and maximizing space utilization. This ensures a clearly identified and defined flow of volume from origin to destination.

4. Streamlining of Processes

- **Unique Mail Pattern:** A mail routing system designed for **PAN (Presence Across Nation)** India coverage, reducing the complexity of the working network.
- **Transit Time Targets:** Targets for each NSH are set based on mail network availability and geographical locations.
- **Sorting Schedule:** Speed-Net NTD (National to Delivery) sorting is scheduled before TD (Turn District/Local) sorting to optimize **D+X** delivery norms.
- **Rationalized Logic:** Sorting logic is rationalized based on actual volume reported.
- **Specialization:** Labour is specialized into scanners and sorters.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) Overview

The following targets are established for key metrics:

Sr. No.	Key Performance Indicator	Target
1	D+X (NTD)	Average Time 2 days
2	D+X (TD)	Average Time 1.28 days
3	Inbound operational performance	100% (Implied)
4	Share of bags without 'correct' bag labels	0%

Additional KPI Targets

- Share of 'mis-sorted' articles (NTD): **1%**
- Share of 'mis-sorted' articles (TD): **5%**
- Share of articles with 'missing' pin codes: **1%**
- Share of duplicate barcodes: **0%**
- Full Scan Compliance (TD): **90%**
- Full Scan Compliance (NTD): **80%**
- TD articles without Delivery Scan / Information: **5%**

Establishment of Performance Reviews

Performance of each Speed Post hub is monitored and reviewed every **fortnight** based on KPIs computed using information on the Central Server. **11 Unique KPIs** are set up to ensure every mail activity is tracked, including Transit time, scan compliance, mis-sorts, duplicate barcodes, missing pin-codes, and invalid bag-labels.

Effective Monitoring Tools

Better monitoring and control of the network are achieved through tools such as:

1. **BI Tool** (Business Intelligence)
2. **IPVS** (India Post Visibility System)
3. **AWB Tracking**

Implications of MNOP KPIs (RMS Units)

KPI #1: D+X TD

- **Definition:** The average time taken in days for TD articles from booking by the customer to delivery to the recipient.
- **Scope:** Articles booked at offices in the local TD and catchment area of a given NSH and delivered at Post Offices in the local TD and catchment area of the *same* given NSH.

KPI #2: D+X NTD

- **Definition:** The average time taken in days by NTD articles from booking by the customer to delivery to the recipient.
- **Scope:** Articles booked at offices in the local TD and catchment area of a given NSH (Sorting hub) and delivered at Post Offices of the catchment area of National Sorting Hubs *other than* the given NSH.
- **Implication:** Time taken for processing of articles after receipt at processing units and further connection to available Flight/schedules is taken into account for the calculation of **D+X**.

KPI #3: Inbound Operational Performance

- **Definition:** Performance of the destination Hub to deliver all inbound TD articles in the next possible delivery round.
- **Cut-off Times:**
 - **Metros:** All articles received at Sorting Hub from **7:00 AM on day D-1** to **7:00 AM on day D**.
 - **Non-Metros:** All articles received at Sorting Hub from **3:00 AM on day D-1** to **3:00 AM on day D**.
- **Implication:** Time taken for processing of bags received before the cut-off time and their connection to available schedules for same-day delivery is calculated.

KPI #4: Share of Bags without Correct Bag Labels

- **Definition:** All bags closed at the Processing Hub having their bag closing scan in the system are checked for the correctness of their Bag ID.

- **Implication:** Processing units must use correct bag labels as per the category of articles:
 - Speed Document & Parcel and RL: **EB_1234567890**
 - Registered Packets (RP): **RB_1234567890**
 - India Post Parcel: **CB_1234567890**
 - Ordinary Letter: **LB_1234567890**

KPI #5: Share of Mis-sorted Articles (NTD)

- **Definition:** For all bags closed at a Sorting Hub, bag labels hold information for the delivery Sorting Hub. The Pin code of the Delivery PO of an article is compared with the Delivery POs mapped to the destination Sorting Hub to which the article is bagged.
- **Logic:** If the Pin code of the Delivery PO differs from the Pin code of delivery POs mapped to that particular destination Sorting Hub, the article is treated as an NTD Mis-sort.

KPI #6: Share of Mis-sorted Articles (TD)

- **Definition:** The **6-digit Pin code** of the PO to which the article is bagged is compared with the Pin code of the PO at which it is delivered. If they differ, the article is treated as a TD Mis-sort.
- **Implication:** This KPI pertains to all articles mis-sorted at the processing units during sorting and bag closing.

KPI #7: Share of Articles with Missing Pin Codes

- **Definition:** Assesses how many articles were booked at POs and booking units in the catchment area of the Sorting hub without a **6-digit** addressee Pin Code.

KPI #8: Share of Duplicate Barcodes

- **Definition:** Assesses how many articles were booked by reusing barcodes within a prescribed time.
- **Implication:** Bulk booking units (like BNPLs) booking articles with the wrong Pin Code or duplicate barcodes will negatively affect this KPI.

Scan Compliance Protocols

KPI #9: Full Scan Compliance (TD)

Percentage of TD articles having all **8 scans** out of total articles delivered.

The 8 Mandatory Scans for TD Articles:

1. PO/Sorting Hub Booking Scan
2. PO/Sorting Hub Dispatch Scan
3. Sorting Hub MA/TMO Receipt Scan
4. Sorting Hub Bag Opening Scan
5. Sorting Hub Bag Closing Scan
6. Sorting Hub MA/TMO Dispatch Scan
7. Delivery PO Receipt Scan
8. Delivery PO Final Delivery Scan

Mandatory Scans for BNPL TD Articles:

For BNPL TD category articles, **5 Scans** are mandatory:

1. Article Booking Scan
2. Article Dispatch Scan
3. Mail Agency Dispatch Scan
4. Article Receipt at Post Office Scan
5. Delivery Scan at Post Office

KPI #10: Full Scan Compliance (NTD)

Percentage of NTD articles having all **12 scans** out of total articles delivered.

The 12 Mandatory Scans for NTD Articles:

1. PO/Sorting Hub Booking Scan
2. PO/Sorting Hub Dispatch Scan
3. Origin Sorting Hub MA/TMO Receipt Scan
4. Origin Sorting Hub Bag Opening Scan

5. Origin Sorting Hub Bag Closing Scan
6. Origin Sorting Hub MA/TMO Dispatch Scan
7. Destination Sorting Hub MA/TMO Receipt Scan
8. Destination Sorting Hub Bag Opening Scan
9. Destination Sorting Hub Bag Closing Scan
10. Destination Sorting Hub MA/TMO Dispatch Scan
11. Destination PO Receipt Scan
12. Destination PO Final Delivery Scan

Implication: Out of these, **4 scans** are mandatory for *each* processing unit (origin & destination): Bag Receipt, Bag Opened, Bag Closed, and Bag Dispatch.

Mandatory Scans for BNPL NTD Articles:

For BNPL NTD category articles, **9 Scans** are mandatory:

1. Article Booking Scan
2. Article Dispatch Scan
3. Mail Agency Dispatch Scan
4. Bag Receipt Scan at Destination NSH
5. Articles Receipt Scan at NSH
6. Articles Dispatch Scan at NSH
7. Bag Dispatch Scan at NSH
8. Article Receipt at Post Office Scan
9. Delivery Scan at Post Office

KPI #11: TD Articles Without Delivery Scan/Information

- **Definition:** For TD articles, the percentage of articles booked on a given date that get scanned for final delivery in the next **5 working days**.
- **Implication:** If TD articles received at the processing unit are not timely processed and connected to available schedules, this KPI is affected.

Project Objectives and Coverage

MNOP Project Components

1. Optimization and consolidation of the mail operation network across the country.
2. Process redesign in mail operations for greater efficiency.
3. Standardization of processes.
4. Development of an effective online performance monitoring system based on Key Performance Indicators (KPIs).

MNOP Project Coverage

The entire country, covering Speed Post and unregistered mail, is brought into the fold after the product and network revamp.

MNOP-Mail Network Optimization Project Concept

(w.e.f. 01.04.2025)

SI/NO	Mail Item	Number of NSHs/L1/NPH	Number of ICHs/L2/PH
1.	Speed Post Document, Registered Letter	95 NSHs	163 ICHs
2.	First Class Unregistered	96 L1	207-L2
3.	Second Class Unregistered	96 L1	207-L2
4.	Speed Post Parcel & India Post Parcel: 189 PHs	79 NPH	110 PH

Delivery Norms of All types of Articles

Type of Article	Local (within municipal city Limit) (in days)	Between Metro City (Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Bangalore, Kolkata and Hyderabad) (in days)	Same State (in days)	Neighbouring State (In days)	Rest of the country (in days)
First Class (Registered)	2	2-3	3-4	3-4	5-6
First Class (Unregistered)	2	2-3	3-4	3-4	5-6
Second Class	3	4	4	4	5-7
India Post Parcel	2-3	3-4	4	4	5-7
Speed Post	1-2	1-3	1-4	1-4	4-5

Features of Monitoring System

1. Performance monitoring of each hub based on **11 different KPIs** (Transit time, scan compliance, delivery office performance, use of PIN code, mis-sorts, etc.)
2. No human intervention in data extraction and no scope for manipulation of the system.
3. **24×7** Online availability of data with user credentials at all levels.
4. Enables field units to find out weak elements in the chain and take effective remedial action.
5. Performance monitoring through video conference every **fortnight** chaired by Secretary.

Achievements under the Scheme

1. Reduced transit time (time from booking to delivery of an article) and improved delivery performance for Speed Post across the country (more than **60%** of articles get delivered across the country within **two days** of booking).

2. Improved visibility for Speed Post articles on the tracking system of India Post website (www.indiapost.gov.in) (end-to-end status of Speed Post articles is available online for about **89%** Speed Post articles).
3. Standardized processes at Speed Post operations have led to streamlined operations, better monitoring, and enhanced productivity.
4. The introduction of new tools and equipment in operations has led to better working conditions for the employees.
5. **Improved sorting process:**
 - Volume-based Sorting logic was introduced.
 - A sorting diagram was designed to suit this logic.
 - A new sorting case was designed.
 - **Adequate equipment and infrastructure:** New roller containers, trays, trolleys, and bag cutters were used.
 - Computers, scanners, printers, and internet connectivity were provided.
6. The online KPI tool has provided an effective mechanism for performance measurement for the management at different levels.
7. The complaint handling system has become very effective and responsive.

Modernise the Look and Feel of Mail Offices through MNOP

MNOP has provided for improving the ambiance of Mail Offices i.e., improved Look and Feel of Mail Offices and to be more trustworthy and reliable by upgrading the processing facilities.

Award for the MNOP Concept

National E-Governance Award **2012-13** under the category "Outstanding performance in citizen-centric service delivery" by Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievance (DARPG), Government of India was awarded for MNOP Initiative to Department of Posts.

Policy Guidelines on Delivery of Postal Articles by Delivery Staff through their Own Two-Wheeler Vehicle

The following types of delivery staff engaged in Departmental post offices including NDCs will be covered under the guidelines:

1. Regular Postman staff.
2. Gramin Dak Sewaks (GDS)/ABPM including GDS Mail Carrier (MC).
3. Other Departmental staff being engaged for delivery work.
4. Outsourced delivery staff.

Postman Ad-hoc Establishment Norms for 2-wheeler beats (Mechanized Delivery Beat)

S.No.	Items	Congested area in minutes	Non-Congested area in minutes	Remark
1	Distance travelled by Foot	19 Minutes/KM	12 Minutes/KM	Adhoc norms
2	By Bicycle	10 Minutes/KM	06 Minutes/KM	
3	By 2-wheeler vehicle	5 Minutes/KM	03 Minutes/KM	

Modalities for Allowing Reimbursement for Fuel Charges

Documents to be Checked

Following documents are to be checked by APM (Delivery)/postmaster or any other official supervising the delivery work and kept in guard file to be maintained in Delivery Post Office before allowing the reimbursement of vehicle mileage charges to the delivery staff:

- Valid 2-wheeler driving license in the name of the person doing delivery.
- Copy of the Registration certificate of the 2-wheeler vehicle.
- Copy of insurance certificate of the two-wheeler vehicle.
- The vehicle should be owned by the delivery staff or owned by the immediate family members of the delivery staff.

- In case the vehicle is owned by the immediate family member of the delivery staff, a declaration to this effect from the delivery staff should be obtained and placed in guard file at Delivery Post Office.
- In case the vehicle is not owned by delivery staff or immediate family member then an authorization letter from vehicle owner, in the name of delivery staff be obtained and kept in record.

Note: While allowing the fuel re-imbursement charges to the GDS MC, Circles must also rationalize the number of GDS MC required for carrying the BO bag to the Branch Post offices considering the saving of time due to mechanization.

Calculation of Average Distance Travelled in Beat

Daily reimbursement charges to be paid to the delivery staff will be based on the average km travelled by the delivery staff during the "observation period" as detailed below.

- **Observation Period:** Average of the distance travelled by the Delivery Staff during **6 working days**.
- The distance travelled through 2-wheeler vehicle by delivery staff during observation period will be checked daily by the APM (Delivery)/Postmaster or any other official supervising the delivery work.
- Besides, meter reading of the 2-wheeler vehicle before the delivery staff departs for the delivery and return from the delivery will also be noted down in a Register.
- Any complete week of **6 working days** can be selected by the Postal Divisions for the 'Observation Period'.
- This exercise may preferably be carried out during **April month** of each year.

Linkage with Mobile App Usage

Payment of reimbursement charges to the delivery staff for usage of their own 2-wheeler vehicle will be linked with the usage of Postman Mobile App. In order to be eligible for the fuel reimbursement charges, at least **95%** of the accountable articles during the period (for which claim pertains) should be processed through IMA.

Manner of Submission of Fuel Reimbursement Claim Form

The delivery staff will submit a Fuel Reimbursement claim form for reimbursement of fuel charges in the prescribed format on the **1st working day** of month for the previous month with details of:

- Number of Accountable articles delivered on each date.
- Delivery efficiency of accountable articles.
- % of articles handled in IMA.
- Average distance per day in the month for which fuel reimbursement charges are being claimed.

Rate of Reimbursement of Fuel Charges to Delivery Staff

The rate is calculated as: Average expenditure on periodic maintenance per K.M. (Rs. 0.98) + Average fuel charges per K.M.

- **Average Fuel charge per K.M.:** Fuel Price in the respective stage / Average mileage of the bike (i.e., 40 K.M./Litre).

Linkage with Delivery Performance

Payment of reimbursement charges to the delivery staff for usage of their own 2-wheeler vehicle will be linked with the delivery performance of accountable articles as indicated below:

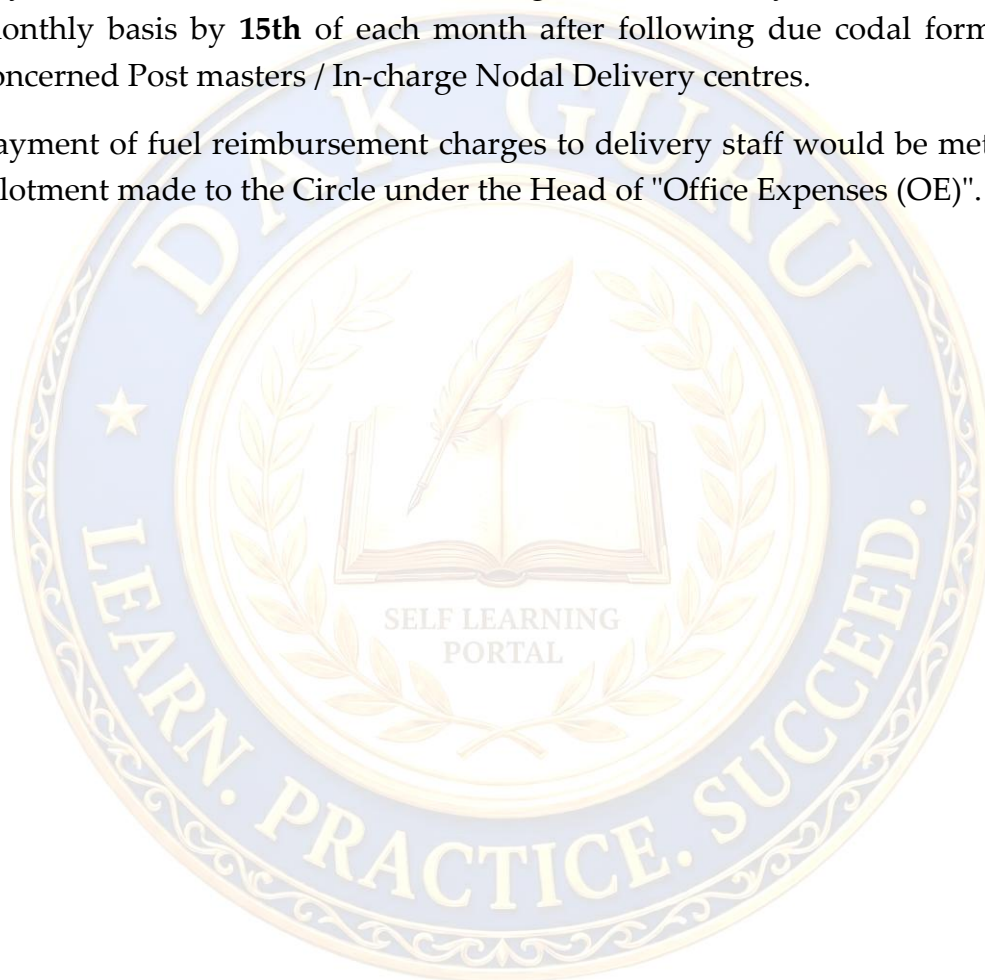
S.No.	Delivery Performance (Process of Article)	Reimbursement Charges
1	If delivery performance is 95% or more than 95%	100% payment of calculated charges
2	If delivery performance is between 90% to 94.9%	80% payment of calculated charges

Action by APM Mails/ Post Office In-charge

APM (Delivery)/Postmaster or any other official supervising the delivery work at Post office will randomly check the genuineness of the delivery of Accountable articles at the door step of addressee in respect of at least **5 Accountable articles** from the delivery manifest through the "IMA-Beat Delivery Report" available on CEPT MIS portal on a daily-basis.

Accounting and Payment of Fuel Reimbursement Charges

- After checking the entries made by the delivery staff in the Fuel Reimbursement Form by the delivery staff, the APM (Delivery)/Postmaster will ensure to submit the bills to the Divisional Office for sanctioning the same by **5th** of each month.
- Concerned Divisional Heads will sanction the bills of Fuel Reimbursement charges by **10th** of each month.
- Payment of reimbursement of fuel charges to the delivery staff would be done on monthly basis by **15th** of each month after following due codal formalities by concerned Post masters / In-charge Nodal Delivery centres.
- Payment of fuel reimbursement charges to delivery staff would be met from the allotment made to the Circle under the Head of "Office Expenses (OE)".



Parcel Network Optimization Project (PNOP)

A new and separate network consisting of **189 Parcel Hubs**, including **79 NPH/Level-1 (L1)** and **110 PH/Level-2 (L2)** hubs for handling parcels has been approved. (As on 01.04.2025)

- Speed Post Parcel and India Post Parcel are being processed in Parcel Hubs.
- In order to process all types of Parcels in Parcel Hubs following bags pattern is followed at present:

A. India Post Parcel

1. **Post Office to mapped Parcel Hub:** Separate TD & NTD Parcel Bags.
2. **Parcel Hub to Parcel Hub:** Parcel Bag.
3. **Parcel Hub to mapped delivery Post Office/NDC:** Parcel Bag.

B. Speed Post Parcel

1. **Post Office to mapped Parcel Hub:** Separate TD and NTD Speed Post Bag.
2. **Parcel Hub to Parcel Hub:** Speed Post Bag.
3. **Parcel Hub to mapped delivery Post Office/NDC:** Speed Post Bag.

Bag Label Color Codes

The parcel bag label will be in two colours:

- **Yellow:** For Air connectivity (For Speed Post Parcel).
- **Blue:** For Surface connectivity (For India Post Parcel).

Setup of Nodal Delivery Centre (NDC)

- **Location Criteria:** Metros and all other cities/towns where Parcel density exceeds 1 Parcel per Sq K.M.
- **Space Standards:** The standard area of an ideal layout for Nodal Delivery Centre is 1595 Sq Ft.
- **Postman Delivery Bag Norms:**
 - Dimension: 45cm x 35cm x 56cm

- Weight of bag: **2 Kg**
- Carrying capacity: **30 KG**

Delivery Norms for Nodal Delivery Centres

- **Two-Wheelers:** **50-60 parcels** in two trips (i.e., **30-35 parcels** in the first trip and remaining parcels in the second trip).
- **Four-Wheelers:** Would be used to deliver bigger parcels (typically **>2 Kg**). Target: **70-80 such parcels** per four-wheeler.

Speed Post Articles Qualifying as Parcels

Speed Post articles will qualify as a parcel provided any one of the following conditions are met:

1. The weight of the Speed Post article is exceeding **500 grams**.
2. The Dimensions of Speed Post article is beyond **38cms x 27cms x 2cms**.
3. The Customer declares the contents of the Speed Post article as merchandise.

Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) Scheme

- **Scope:** Delivery staff (Postmen/GDS/Outsource) will bring their own device for running apps of DoP & IPPB.
- **Remuneration:**
 - Fixed incentive of **Rs. 300/-** per smartphone per month.
 - **Rs. 200/-** per month for SIM/Data/SMS charges.
 - *(Effective from 25.06.2025).*
- **Security:** Mobile Device Management software will be installed by IPPB for providing necessary security for running of IPPB application.

Calculation of BYOD Remuneration in Special Cases

1. Device Remuneration:

If an employee registered for BYOD scheme does not use the mobile phone due to absence, mobile phone service/repair etc., the remuneration shall be given as:

Remuneration = 300 x No. of working days for which mobile phone was used (Divided By) No. of working days in a month

2. Mobile Tariff Remuneration:

Similarly, mobile tariff remuneration shall be calculated as:

Tariff = 200 x No. of working days for which mobile phone was used (Divided By) No. of working days in a month

3. Exceptional Cases (Full Remuneration):

Full remuneration for a particular month is proposed in the following cases:

- (a) If an employee delivers articles using IMA for at least once a month provided the employee processed minimum **90%** articles and proceeded on leave duly sanctioned by the competent authority.
- (b) If the delivery through IMA could not be done due to technical issues in the mobile phone and is repaired by the delivery staff within **2 working days**. A copy of the bill for mobile phone service/repair may be produced by the delivery staff for this purpose.
- If a mobile phone of outsourced staff is used for delivery through IMA in the absence of departmental staff, outsourced staff may be remunerated for that period in the similar manner as mentioned in the calculation.

Timeline for Processing of Reimbursement under BYOD

S.No.	Activity Details	Timeline (on or before)
1.	Verification of BYOD Criteria: Supervisor/APM/PM shall verify that the criteria of handling (not delivery) of 90% of articles through IMA is met either by DPMS or IMA beat delivery report on a daily basis.	3rd Working Day of every month
2.	Forwarding the Claim: The reimbursement claim of eligible delivery staff will then be forwarded to concerned PM/CPM/Div. Head etc.	5th Working Day of every month
3.	Processing & Sanctioning: Sanctioning authority shall inspect the records and ensure that reimbursement is processed timely subject to availability of funds.	15th Working Day of every month

Parcel Packaging Policy

There are three aspects of parcel packaging:

1. **External packaging:** Flyer, Boxes, Bi-axially Oriented Polypropylene (BOPP) tapes, stretch wrap plastic films & strapping rolls.
2. **Internal packaging:** Loose fill like Bubble wrap, airbags & cardboard fillers.
3. **Special Handling label:** Labels indicating handling instructions for fragile items.

Specifications of Packaging Material

Type	Usage	Thickness	Carrying Capacity
Plastic Flyer/bag	For securing parcels	55-60 microns	Less than 2 Kg
Paper Flyer/bag	For securing parcels	100-150 microns	Less than 2 Kg
BOPP Tape	Securing & fastening	40 microns	-
Boxes	Protect parcel during transit	-	Single Wall: 1kg, 2Kg, 5kg, 10kg Double Wall: 15kg, 25kg, & 35Kg

PNOP Dashboard

PNOP Dashboard is a dashboard set up by CEPT, Mysore for better monitoring of the PNOP project activities by the Parcel & Citizen Centric Services Directorate. The dashboard monitors civil works, procurement of standardized equipment, and operationalization of Parcel Hubs and Nodal Delivery Centres (NDC). It is updated by the Circles regularly on a day-to-day basis.

Key Data Points for Periodic Update:

1. **Layout Design:** Preparation, submission, and approval.
2. **Standard Equipment:** Assessment and procurement (Opening tables, Roller container, Package Trolley, bag stand, sorting case).

3. **IT Equipment:** Computer & peripherals, barcode scanner, weighing machine including SWS/DWS.
 4. **Civil and Electric Work:** Site Preparation.
 5. **Layout implementation:** Actual implementation of approved layout with floor marking.
 6. **RTN Movements:** Option to update Road Transport Network movements to monitor adherence to time and schedule.
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Required Operational Area for a Parcel Hub

1. Very-Small Category Parcel Hub

- Operational Area: 575 Sq ft
- Processing Capacity: Up to 500 parcels per eight hours shift.
- Throughput: Less than or equal to 120 parcels per hour.
- Sort Destinations: 140 destinations.

2. Small Category Parcel Hub

- Operational Area: 1200 Sq ft
- Processing Capacity: Up to 1500 parcels per eight hours shift.
- Throughput: 121 to 250 parcels per hour.
- Sort Destinations: 144 destinations.

3. Medium Category Parcel Hub

- Operational Area: 2840 Sq ft
- Processing Capacity: Up to 3000 parcels per eight hours shift.
- Throughput: 251 to 500 parcels per hour.
- Sort Destinations: 180 destinations.

4. Large Category Parcel Hub

- Operational Area: 8456 Sq ft
 - Processing Capacity: Up to 8400 parcels per eight hours shift.
-

- Throughput: **501 to 1400 parcels per hour.**
- Sort Destinations: **192 destinations.**

Static Weight System (SWS) Specifications

Parameter	Specification
Weight measurement Unit	Grams (gms)
Dimension measurement Unit	Millimetre (mm)
Maximum weight capacity	35 Kg
Least count for weight measurement	20 gms
Least count for dimension	10 mm or better
Minimum object size (LxBxH)	100 mm x 50 mm x 20 mm
Maximum object size (LxBxH)	600 mm x 600 mm x 600 mm
Data capture	Connection to PC; Auto-transfer of weight/dimension within 1 second.
Measurement time	Maximum 3 Seconds
Platform size	Length or breadth: At least 2 feet but not exceeding 2 feet 6 inches.
Warranty	One-year comprehensive warranty + AMC/Calibration.

Parcel Sorting Case

- Standard preparation: **15 (5x3)** pigeon holes.
- Local customization options: **12 (4x3)** and **9 (3x3)** pigeon holes.

Presumptive Loss Policy

If a bag/parcel is not traced within **5 days**, presumptive loss would need to be recovered from the officials at fault.

Calculation of Presumptive Loss:

1. **Lost/Abstracted Parcel:** The amount of maximum compensation which the Department may have to pay to the customer for their parcel.
2. **Lost Bag:** The amount of maximum compensation which the Department may have to pay to the customers for *all* the parcels invoiced in the bag.

Dealing with Inward Errors

1. Office In-charge Action:

When an office receives an error report, the in-charge will try to resolve it based upon the work papers available.

2. RMS Office:

- If not resolved, the Record Officer will notify the in-charge of the Set (MA in case of TMO) against which the error report has been made within **2 days** from the date of receipt of error.
- If the in-charge/MA fails to give a satisfactory reply within **3 days**, the HRO/SRO will initiate the process of recovery of presumptive loss, if not already recovered.

3. Post Office:

- If not resolved, the Office in-charge will initiate the process of recovery of presumptive loss within **5 days** of receipt of error.

4. Divisional Office Action:

- (a) Monitor errors issued/received by offices under its control.
- (b) Initiate appropriate action for recovery of presumptive loss from identified erring officials in a time-bound manner (recovery to be made within a period of **45 days** from the day of discrepancy).
- (c) Maintain a register for monitoring recovery.

PNOP Forms List

S.No	Form No.	Description	Prepared At
1	1A	Receipt of Bag	Mail Agency/TMO, Post Office/NDC
2	1B	Despatch of Bag	Mail Agency/TMO, Post Office/NDC
3	1C	TB Dispatch	Mail Agency/TMO, Post Office/NDC
4	1D	TB Summary	Mail Agency/TMO, Post Office/NDC
5	1E	Bag Abstract	Mail Agency/TMO, Post Office/NDC
6	1F	Bag Abstract (Where PH & MA work separately)	Parcel Hub
7	2A	Receipt of Article	Parcel Hub, Post Office/NDC
8	2B	Despatch of Article	Parcel Hub, Post Office/NDC
9	2C	Receipt & Despatch Summary	Parcel Hub
10	2D	Parcel Abstract	Parcel Hub, Post Office/NDC
11	3A	Inward Error Register	Record Office, Post Office
12	3B	Outward Error Register	Record Office, Post Office
13	3C	Inward Error Register	Record Office, Post Office
14	3D	Outward Error Register	Record Office, Post Office
15	3E	Inward Error Register	Division Office, Post Office
16	3F	Outward Error Register	Division Office, Post Office

KPI to Review Booking, Despatch, and Delivery Performance of Speed Post & India Post Parcel

There are total **33 KPIs** to monitor Booking, Despatch, and Delivery performance of Speed Post & India Post Parcel developed by CEPT/CSI.

Trans-Shipment Centre under PNOP

The following **9 centres** would be utilized for the purpose of transportation of parcels/mails through the **Road Transport Network (RTN)**:

1. Guwahati (Assam)
2. Sagar (Madhya Pradesh)
3. Chennai (Tamil Nadu)
4. Siliguri (West Bengal)
5. Bengaluru (Karnataka)
6. Nabadiganta (West Bengal)
7. Golconda (Hyderabad)
8. Nagpur (Maharashtra)
9. Ludhiana (Punjab)

Capacity:

- Movement of **5 trucks**.
- Storage of **1000 bags (50 roller containers)**.
- **2 goods lifts** and vertical extension of **2 more floors**.

Joint Parcel Product (JPP): Express Cargo Service

- A collaborative parcel product of **India Post** and **Indian Railways**.
- This project is covered under **PM Gati Shakti - National Master Plan for Multi-modal Connectivity**.
- The first run under PoC was successfully conducted from **Surat to Varanasi** on **31/03/2022** with **08 tons** load in **Tapti Ganga Express (19045)**.
- Parcel Product in the Weight Category of **35 Kg to 100 Kg** from B2C & B2B with focus on MSMEs.
- **India Post** to provide First Mile Collection and Booking and Last Mile - Delivery.
- **Indian Railways** will provide the Middle Mile - Transportations from Origin to Destination.
- Booking of the Parcels on **PMS (Railways)** at Aggregation Centre.
- The booked parcel shall be put inside the boxes/Containers (specially designed by Railway) which shall be locked and sealed by Department of Posts in the presence of Railway representative.
- **Third Party insurance** to provide End to End protection.
- Flexibility of opting out First or Last Mile and getting relative discount in the rate.
- As per Directorate Letter No. 25-01/2022-D dated **28.10.2022**, it is clarified that now Customer will have an option to opt for First Mile and last Mile services as per customer's requirements.

JPP Charges Structure

Activity	Amount inclusive GST (in Rs.) per Kg
Only First Mile (Pick up, Booking & Handing over to Railways at origin)	4
Only Last Mile (Booking, Handing over to Railways at Origin and Delivery by Destination Centre)	4
First Mile and Last Mile both (All above Activities)	6

Note: Insurance Charges @ 0.03% of Content Value + GST @ 18% will be levied in Addition to Above tariff. (Through M/s Bajaj Allianz General Insurance Company Ltd).

Middle Mile Charges of Railway

- 10% over the scale applicable for that particular train.
- During the PoC, charging for trains running at "R" Scale shall be at **R + 10%**.
- For trains running at "P" Scale shall be at **P + 10%**.

Present Rate structure for Tapti Ganga Express (19045) from Surat to Varanasi:

Sr. No.	Train Name	Destination	Distance	Railway Charges (With GST)	India Post Handling Charges (FM + LM)	Total charges* Per KG (With GST)
1	Tapti Ganga Express (19045)	Varanasi	1402 KMs	6.60	6.00	12.60

Parcel Hub & NDC Design Manual

Categorization of Parcel Hubs

Parcel hubs can be categorised based on the level of automation adopted within the facility:

1. **Manual parcel hub facility:** A facility where the primary as well as secondary sorting of the parcels is done manually.
2. **Semi-automated parcel hub facility:** A facility where the primary sorting of parcels is done by an automated sorter (e.g., arm sorter, cross-belt sorter, tilt-tray sorter, pop-up sorter etc.).
3. **Automated parcel hub facility:** A facility where the primary sorting of parcels is done by an automated sorter as described above and the secondary sorting is done automatically or is assisted by a **Put-To-Light (PTL)** system.

Operational Areas in a Parcel Hub Facility

1. Bag Receipt Area:

Area where closed parcel bags are unloaded from vehicles or equipment (in the case of facilities located at railway stations) and received by the facility.

2. Pre-Sort Staging Area:

Area where the received parcel bags are stored/staged before they are taken for further processing.

3. Bag Opening Area:

Area where the received parcel bags are opened, the parcels contained in the bags are taken out and received, and the received parcels are thereafter segregated based on the type such as:

- **Forward parcel:** Parcels on onward journey for delivery.
- **Return parcel:** Undelivered parcels to be returned to shipper/sender.
- **Reject parcels:** Parcels that cannot be processed due to lack of data.

4. Primary Sorting Area:

Area where the first level sorting (preliminary sorting) of the parcels is undertaken. A primary sorting area can contain single or multiple secondary sorting stations for carrying out detailed sorting. In certain cases, the activity of primary sorting may be clubbed with the bag opening activity in the bag opening area itself depending upon the parcel volume.

5. Secondary Sorting Area:

Area within the facility where second level sorting (detailed sorting) of parcels is undertaken to sort them to their respective destinations.

- Includes closing parcels into bags, printing manifests, putting manifests inside bags, and closing bags (system and physical seal).
- **Weighing:** IP enabled weighing scales can be provisioned here or at the post-sort staging area.

6. Returns Processing Area:

Area within the facility where the parcels that are marked to be returned to shipper/sender are processed before sending them for primary sorting or sending them directly to the shipper/sender (for consolidated returns in the case of a large sender).

7. Large Parcel Processing Area:

A separate area within the facility where processing of large parcels or packages (defined as parcels large enough to fill a single bag) is undertaken.

8. Post Sort Staging Area:

Area within the facility where the closed parcel bags from the secondary sorting area, returns processing area, or large parcel processing area are taken to wherein they are sorted and staged/stored as per their respective destinations before they are dispatched through respective schedules.

9. Bag Dispatch Area:

Area within the facility where closed parcel bags are loaded onto vehicles or equipment and dispatched by the facility.

10. Data Admin & Booking Area:

Area within the facility where any data entry related work such as data validation, correction, or fresh data entry is undertaken. Any booking related activities like uploading XML files received from bulk customers etc. are also typically undertaken here.

Flow of Operational Activities in the Facility

1. **Bag Receipt Area:** Vehicles with bags arrive; Bags are unloaded & received.
 2. **Pre Sort Staging Area:** Bags arranged in trolleys in order of priority for processing.
 3. **Primary Sorting Area:** Bag opening, article receiving & primary sorting done using sort application.
 4. **Secondary Sorting Area:** Secondary sorting, bag closing, and manifest printing done.
 5. **Post Sort Staging Area:** Bag weighing, bag routing label printing & pasting, and bag staging done.
 6. **Bag Dispatch Area:** Bags are loaded & dispatched; Vehicles with bags depart.
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Key Operational Equipment in the Facility

Key Equipment Name	Primary Purpose	Handling Capacity	Floor Footprint (Dimension & Area)
Roller Container	To be used for moving closed bags (containing parcels) or large parcels in the facility.	Can hold up to 20 closed parcel bags with each bag containing 10 parcels. Equal to 200 parcel holding capacity (700 Kgs).	Dimension: 5 ft. x 3 ft. Area footprint: 15 sq. ft.
Package Trolley	To be used for moving parcels within the facility.	Can hold up to 50 parcels (300 Kgs).	Dimension: 3 ft. x 2 ft. Area footprint: 6 sq. ft.
Bag Opening Table	To be used for opening closed bags and receiving the parcels contained therein.	Can process 250 or 350 parcels per hour (depending on if primary sorting is included) (300 Kgs).	Dimension: 4 ft. x 2.5 ft. Area footprint: 10 sq. ft.
Bag Stand	To be used for secondary sorting of parcels for high volume destinations directly into empty bags.	One Bag Stand can hold 6, 8 or 10 bags in position based on size.	6 Bags: 4'10" x 3'3" (15.7 sq ft)

			8 Bags: 6'5" x 3'3" (20.9 sq ft) 10 Bags: 8' x 3'3" (26 sq ft)
Sorting Case	To be used for secondary sorting of parcels for low volume destinations.	Each pigeon hole can hold up to 16 parcels .	9 Holes: 5'2.8" x 1'6.4" (8 sq ft) 12 Holes: 5'11.1" x 1'6.4" (~10.6 sq ft) 15 Holes: 8'7.5" x 1'6.4" (13.2 sq ft)
Computers	To be used for processing of the parcels in the system.	Not applicable.	Stand: 2 ft. x 2 ft. (4 sq. ft.) Table: Equal to size of table.
Thermal Printers	To be used for printing of bag labels or return parcel routing labels.	Not applicable.	Not applicable (peripheral).
Printers	To be used for printing of bag manifest, delivery bill etc.	Not applicable.	Not applicable (peripheral).
IP Enabled weighing scale	To be used for weighing closed bags.	Can weigh 120 small parcel bags or 150 large parcel bags per hour.	Dimension: 3 ft. x 3 ft. Area footprint: 9 sq. ft.

Static Weighing System (SWS)	To be used for measuring weight and dimensions of parcels received for booking.	Can easily handle 360 parcels per hour .	Dimension: 3 ft. x 3 ft. Area footprint: 9 sq. ft.
Table (Data Admin/Booking)	To facilitate processing of parcels, placement of computer/printer.	Not applicable.	Dimension: 4 ft. x 2 ft. Area footprint: 8 sq. ft.

Key Aspects of Facility Design Specifications

Design Specification	Explanation
Volume	Number of parcels that are required to be processed by the sorting facility in different shifts. This ensures adequate equipment and space. (e.g., 3000 articles per shift).
Operational Hours	Total time in hours in a shift during which all operational activities happen simultaneously. (e.g., 6 hours actual operational hours in an 8-hour shift).
Throughput	Maximum number of parcels that would need to be processed per hour. This helps in allocating equipment and space. (e.g., 500 articles per hour).
Sort Destinations	Number of destinations for which the facility must sort parcels. (e.g., 160 destinations including TD and NTD).

Floor Marking Guidelines

Floor Marking Color	Guidelines for use
Blue Color	Used to mark processing areas : Pre-sort/Post-sort staging, Bag Opening, Sorting areas, Data admin, Booking, Returns, Bag receipt/dispatch, Secure storage, Stationery area etc.
Green Color	Used to mark equipment and workstations : Roller containers, bag opening table, package trolleys, bag stands, sorting case, sequencing tables, computer stands, SWS, weighing scale, racks etc.
Yellow Color	Used to mark aisles : Common passage, walking pathways, equipment movement pathways etc.

Guideline to Identify Areas That May Be Combined

Category 1 (≤ 120 parcels/hr) & Category 2 (121-250 parcels/hr)

- **Areas that may be separate:** Secondary Sorting area.
- **Areas that may be combined:**
 - Bag receipt and dispatch area (or at TMO).
 - Pre-sort and post-sort staging area (or at TMO).
 - Bag opening, Primary sorting, Data Admin & Booking, Returns, and Large parcel processing can all be combined into the **Bag opening area**.

Category 3 (251-500 parcels/hr)

- **Areas that may be separate:** Pre-sort staging area, Secondary Sorting area, Large parcel processing area.
- **Areas that may be combined:**
 - Bag receipt and dispatch area.
 - Bag opening and Primary sorting area.
 - Data Admin & Booking area and Returns Processing Area.

Category 4 (501-1400 parcels/hr)

- **Areas that may be separate:** Dedicated separate space for all the listed areas.
- **Areas that may be combined:** None.

Nodal Delivery Centre (NDC)

A Nodal Delivery Centre (NDC) is a place where the parcels are received, then sorted as per their delivery address, taken out for delivery as per address and storing/processing undelivered parcels.

- Total **233 NDCs** are covering **1600+ Pincode area**.
- They are located in **145 cities**.

Geographical Locations of NDC

Type of City	No. of NDCs
Tier – I	73
Tier – II	103
Tier – III	57

Activity Flow in an NDC

1. **Bag Receipt:** Bags are received by the NDC.
2. **Staging:** Received bags are staged/stored in a pre-allocated space in the facility until they are to be opened.
3. **Bag Opening:** Received bags are brought and opened in a pre-defined area in the facility.
4. **Parcel Receipt:** Parcels in the opened bags are taken out, received in the system and segregated based on type e.g., parcels with data, parcel with no data etc.
5. **Sector Sorting:** Preliminary sorting of the parcels is done into sectors based on delivery address.
6. **Beat Sorting:** Detailed sorting of the parcels already sorted into sectors is done into delivery beats based on delivery address.
7. **Beat Sequencing:** Sorted parcels in each beat are sequenced as per the beat route.

8. **Out For Delivery:** Sequenced parcels are scanned for taking them out for delivery, arranged in the delivery bag / delivery van as per the beat and taken out for delivery attempt.
9. **Post Delivery Attempt:** Post delivery attempt activities like parcel reconciliation, COD reconciliation, storing undelivered parcels, processing & dispatch of return parcels etc.

Operational Areas in an NDC

The key operational areas in a typical NDC are identified based on the activities to be undertaken in those areas:

1. Receipt & Dispatch Area:

Area where closed bags are unloaded from vehicle and received by the facility and also from where the closed bags containing undelivered parcels to be returned to the origin are dispatched and loaded onto the vehicles.

2. Staging Area:

Area where the received parcel bags are stored/staged before they are taken for processing. Also, the bags to be dispatched containing the return parcels are stored/staged here before they are dispatched and loaded onto a vehicle.

3. Bag Opening & Sector Sorting Area:

Area where the received parcel bags are opened, the parcels contained in the bags are taken out and received, and the received parcels are thereafter segregated into different sectors if the parcel data is available in the system for further processing or identified as parcels for which data is not available in the system also called reject parcels due to which it cannot be further processed.

4. Beat Sorting Area:

Area within the facility where the parcels already sorted into sectors are further sorted into beats by the delivery persons based on the parcel address followed by beat sequencing i.e., sequencing the parcels as per the delivery beat and out for delivery activities that includes scanning the sequenced parcels one by one with "Out for delivery" scan, putting the parcels in the delivery bag / delivery van (to be used in case of large sized parcels) in the **Last-In-First-Out (LIFO)** manner (i.e. the parcel kept last in the delivery bag or delivery van is the one taken out first from the delivery bag / delivery

vehicle respectively and attempted for delivery), printing delivery slip once all the parcels are scanned and kept in the bag, taking all the necessary stationery required for the delivery attempts on the beat and thereafter checking out from the NDC.

- Each beat sorting area will typically have one station allocated within the overall area for processing of large sized parcels which cannot be delivered using bags and need to be delivered using delivery vans.

5. Secure Parcel Storage Area:

Area within the facility where undelivered parcels are kept and secured until they are either to be reattempted for delivery or returned to the origin.

6. Data Admin Area:

Area within the facility where any data entry related work such as data validation or correction or fresh data entry into the system for any of the parcel is undertaken. Any reconciliation activities like COD amount reconciliation, undelivered parcel reconciliation, processing of parcels to be returned to origin etc. is undertaken here. The treasury function as well as the overall data administration related activities for the facility is also typically undertaken from here.

7. Stationery Area:

Area within the facility where the stationery required for processing parcels in the facility or attempting delivery in the delivery beat are kept.

Key Operational Equipment in the NDC

Key Equipment Name	Primary Purpose	Handling Capacity	Floor Footprint (Dimension & Area)
Sequencing Table	To be used for sequencing the parcels already sorted as per the beat.	Can be easily used to sequence 60 parcels at a time (300 Kgs).	Dimension: 6 ft. x 2 ft. Area footprint: 12 sq. ft.

Angle Racks	To be used for storing undelivered parcels (until re-attempt or return as the case maybe) inside a cage that can be locked to be secured.	Should be able to hold undelivered parcels for over a period of 7 days .	Not applicable as the size depends on storage space required. First layer: 1 ft. from ground with width of 1 ft. 6 inch. Total length depends on facility size. Layers: Three layers with each layer of 1 ft. 6 inch height. The top layer is open for bigger/unconventional parcels.
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Key Aspects of Facility Design Specifications (NDC)

Design Specification	Explanation
Volume	Number of parcels that are required to be processed by the NDC in different shifts and the total volume to be handled by the NDC across the shifts. This information is required to ensure that the NDC is designed such that it can handle the identified parcel volume by identifying adequate number of equipment for processing of so many parcels. e.g. 1000 articles to be processed in the NDC in a shift.
Operational Hours	Total time in hours in a shift during which the parcel processing happens in the NDC at the bag opening table which includes bag opening, parcel receipt and sector sorting activities only before they are handed over to the delivery persons for beat sorting. This information is required to identify the duration within which the parcel processing needs to be completed. Further, based on this duration, the delivery person arrival in the facility needs to be planned such that they arrive just a few minutes prior to completion

	of the parcel processing activity at the NDC to start the beat sorting, sequencing and further processing the parcels before going out for delivery attempts. The delivery person should leave the facility within 1 hour of arrival into the facility. e.g. In a shift, the parcel processing (bag opening, receipt, sector sorting) may happen only for 2 hours. The delivery persons arrive shortly before completion.
Throughput	Maximum number of parcels that need to be processed per hour by the NDC at the bag opening table which includes bag opening, parcel receipt and sector sorting activities. This helps in allocating adequate number of equipment and space across different activities. e.g. 500 articles to be processed in the facility per hour (allowing 1000 parcels in 2 hours).
Beats	Number of bike delivery beats and delivery van beats for which the facility must sort the parcels. e.g. 10 bike delivery beats and one delivery van beat for attempting delivery of large parcels covering all the bike delivery beats.

Parcel Operation Manual

The manual seeks to provide clear instructions and guidelines on how to handle parcel products at each stage of processing from booking to delivery.

1. First Mile – Booking processes
2. Middle Mile – Parcel Sorting Centre process
3. Last Mile – Delivery Office processes

1. First Mile - Booking

Ad hoc Norms:

- Norm for booking parcels is **48 parcels per hour**.
- Norm for bagging is **60 Seconds per bag**.
- Norm for parcel bag dispatch scan is **4 bags per minute**.
- Norm for parcel facility in-scan is **720 parcels/hour**.

2. Middle Mile - Parcel Sorting Centre

A. Manual Parcel Processing Centre:

- Pre-sort staging area should be organised in such a way that **FIFO (First-in-First-out)** can be maintained while feeding bags to bag opening or primary sort station.

Ad Hoc Norms (Manual):

- Norm for parcel bag facility in-scan is **4 bags/minute (15 seconds/bag)**.
- Norm for bag opening is **350 parcels/hour** when *only* bag opening & parcel receipt scan activity is done at the bag opening table.
- Norm for bag opening is **250 parcels/hour** when bag opening, parcel receipt scan *and* primary sorting activity is done at the bag opening table.
- Norm for parcel SWS weighment is **6 parcels/minute**.
- Norm for primary sorting of parcels is **700 parcels/hour**.
- Norm for secondary sorting of parcels and bagging (sorting directly into the bags) is **250 parcels/hour**.

- Norm for sorting of bags for post-sort staging is **360 bags per hour**.
- Norm for sorting and bagging at mixed station (sorting parcels into pigeon hole and then put them into bags) is **150 parcels per hour**.
- Norm for parcel bag dispatch scan is **4 bags/minute (15 seconds per bag)**.

B. Semi-Automated Parcel Processing Centre:

Ad Hoc Norms (Semi-Automated):

- Norm for parcel feeding on automated sorter is **1200 parcels/hour**.
- Norm for primary sorting of parcels is as per designed capacity of automatic sorter.

3. Last Mile - Delivery Office

- Delivery bag or delivery vehicle follows **LIFO (Last-In-First-Out)** concept while loading individual parcels i.e. the last parcel that is loaded into the bag or vehicle is the first one to be attempted for delivery.
- **Large Parcels** for the purpose of delivery are those Parcels which are above **2Kg** in weight (physical or volumetric).

Ad Hoc Norms:

- Norm for bag opening, parcel scanning and sector sorting is **250 parcels/hour**.

Parcel Sales Manual

- **Parcel Network Optimization Project (PNOP)** was undertaken by the Department to streamline parcel operations with the vision to capture at least **15%** of the CEP (The Courier, Express & Parcel) market share by **2026**.
- Parcel business in today's definition in India Post primarily focuses on accountable parcel articles namely **Speed Post Parcel, India Post Parcel** and commission earned from **COD parcels** in different categories.
- **Ordinary parcel** is not an accountable article and has not provided any value-added service and traceability in the existing system and therefore is out of the mandate of the Parcel & Citizen Centric Services Directorate presently. Now this product has been discontinued after in force of **PO Regulation 2024**.

Sales Activity

Sales activities are designed to engage potential customers with the objective of customer acquisition and achievement of pre-defined sales target. Sales activities are defined in three types:

1. Sales Target
2. Sales Process
3. Sales Monitoring

1. Sales Target

Sales Target Allocation:

- Sales Target Allocation is an exercise of allocating targets to subordinate units. The annual sales target for the Department for parcel business is decided by the Parcel & Citizen Centric Services Directorate and allotted to Circles.
- The Division further allocates bulk sales target to Marketing Executives and retail sales target to subordinate post offices.
- **Focus of sales target:** Only on **Bulk Sales** (i.e., corporate customers only) and not retail customers.
- **Bulk Definition:** Customers who give a business of **INR 10,000 and above per month** and avail the contractual services of the Department.

Marketing Executive (ME):

- Postal Assistant, Sorting Assistant, PRIs may be designated as Marketing Executive by the Division.
- Some Circles use the nomenclature of **Area Manager** or **Relationship Manager** instead of ME.
- There is no specific qualification for ME, but selection should be based on calibre and competence.
- The MEs should preferably be full time.

What is a Good Target for an ME?

- Close **two sales in one week** which means **100 new bulk customers in a year**.

Timeline for Allocation of Annual Sales Target:

Sr. No.	Activity	Timeline
1	Allocation of yearly sales target to Circles by Parcel & Citizen Centric Services Directorate	Before 5th April
2	Allocation of monthly sales target to Regions by Circles	Before 10th April
3	Allocation of monthly sales target to Divisions by Regions (Circles in case the Division comes directly under a Circle)	Before 15th April
4	Allocation of monthly sales target to MEs by Divisions	Before 25th April

Review & Feedback:

- Review should preferably be done in **December**, so that inputs can be considered for decisions taken for the next financial year.

2. Sales Process

The sales process is divided into six stages:

1. Prospecting:

- Lead Generation
- Pool of Leads
- Selecting Qualified Leads

2. Preparation:

- Research on Qualified Leads
- Obtain Appointment
- Prepare for Presentation

3. Presentation:

- Introduce Self and organisation
- Understand Customer Requirements

- Explain Business Proposition
- Present Products and Services
- Provide Value proposition
- Collect Market Intelligence

4. Managing Objections:

- Preparation of likely Queries
- Query Resolution
- Documentation of Queries

5. Closing:

- Deal Closure
- Contract Signing
- Post-Sales Transfer of Responsibility

6. Follow-up:

- Relationship Management (KAM)
- Up-sell and Cross-sell
- Referrals

Activity Flow for Prospecting

Identify Leads (Potential Clients/ Customers):

MEs shall identify industries and service sector companies/businesses/entities that have the potential to become DOP client in the assigned geography/area.

Collection of Information (Secondary Research Methods):

a. Cold Canvassing:

- Traditional method (generally through phone call).
- Sources: Telephone directory, Publications of Local Market Associations, RWAs, etc.

b. Referrals:

- Asking for referrals from current customers, local contacts/network, other leads.
- Referrals can also materialise from online queries, Department website query, phonic query from staff and from call centre queries.

c. Local Field Offices:

- ME should regularly contact local postal staff (Postman, PRIs, recently retired staff) to gather details of bulk customers.

d. Web Based Research:

- Online research to generate basic information on specific entities.
- Search engines/sites: Google, Justdial, Udaan, Yellow Pages, India Mart, Trade India, Quickr, OLX, Sulekha, Yellowbot, Facebook Marketplace, Instagram/Whatsapp.

e. Web and Variable Data Printers/Publishing Houses:

- All printing and publishing houses are potential customers (e.g., Banks and Insurance companies printing stationery at a single location).

3. Sales Monitoring

The online dashboard created by CEPT (<http://apps.cept.gov.in>) gives ready access to all administrative units for monitoring.

Sales Team Members:**1. KAM (Key Account Manager):**

- Appointed by the Division Office to provide support for each of the bulk customer acquired.
- Supervises the work of the Operation SPOC and handles billing, value adds etc.
- Preferably ASP / ASRM / Dy. Supdt. level.

2. SPOC (Single Point of Contact):

- Appointed by Division Office to provide operations support.

- Empowered to make necessary arrangements like equipment, manpower, pick up, etc.
- Can be PA / SA / IPO / IRM / ASRM level.

3. ME (Marketing Executive):

- Primary work is to identify leads, prepare, present, manage queries, and close the deal.

Responsibility Matrix for Customer Acquisition

Approximate Monthly Demand Value	Level of Official to Make Presentation
Less than or equal to 5 lacs per month ($\leq$ 60 lacs per annum)	Marketing Executive
Greater than INR 5 lacs per month and $\leq$ INR 8 lacs per month ($>$ INR 60 lacs and $\leq$ INR 1 crore per annum)	Divisional Head
Greater than INR 8 lacs per month ($>$ INR 1 crore per annum)	Regional Head

Good Targets

- **Lead Generation Target:** Each ME should at least identify basic information on **two leads daily** (approx. **50 leads per month / 600 leads per year**). At least 50% should be qualified.
- **Qualified Lead Criteria:** Monthly business projected is **Rs. 10,000 and above**.
- **ME Sales Target:** Close **2 sales in one week** (100 new bulk customers in a year).

Tips for Presentation

- Remember the **10-20-30 Rule** for the slideshow:
 - No more than **10 slides**.
 - Lasting not more than **20 minutes**.
 - Use a font size of not less than **30 points**.